



S V V SAI SRI VALLABH PATANENI

Fuel Cell System Engineer · Hydrogen & Fuel Cell R&D

Email vallabh.pataneni@rwth-aachen.de | Phone +49 176 8594 4047
LinkedIn [linkedin.com/in/vallabh-pataneni](https://www.linkedin.com/in/vallabh-pataneni) | Location Renningen / Stuttgart, Germany

PROFILE

Automotive Engineering Master's student at RWTH Aachen who builds fuel cell systems end to end. My work spans air-cooled PEM stack operation and test-bench characterisation at Ecogenium e.V., FCEV energy-management and degradation analysis at Robert Bosch GmbH, and the complete ~150 kW aircraft fuel cell system I am now developing at DLR, covering operating strategy, control, thermal management, sizing, component selection and validation. I am seeking to apply this hands-on fuel cell systems expertise to the hydrogen and fuel cell research at Forschungszentrum Juelich.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Werkstudent, Fuel Cell Systems (Aircraft)
DLR, Innovation Center for Small Aircraft Technologies (INK)

01/2026 – Present
Wuersele (Aachen), Germany

- Fuel Cell System Development:** Developing the complete ~150 kW fuel cell system (the engine) for D-LIGHT, DLR's hydrogen-powered 9-seater feeder aircraft, from concept toward a flight-representative system.
- Thermal-Management Digital Twin:** Built a MATLAB/Simulink digital twin of the full thermal management system to derive design specifications (volumetric flow, coolant temperature range, coolant pressure), driving procurement of the coolant pump and heat exchanger.
- Sizing & Component Selection:** Selected all thermal-management components against the derived specifications and sized the subsystem for the aircraft duty cycle.
- System Rig Design:** Iteratively designed a compact, aircraft-engine-sized fuel cell system rig in CATIA V5, optimised for easy transferability and integration.
- Upcoming Master's Thesis:** Developing the fuel cell system control (start-up, purge control, cathode and anode subsystem control, temperature control, safety protocols) in MATLAB and C++ for direct deployment to the fuel cell controller.

Operating Strategy / System Simulation Intern
Robert Bosch GmbH

09/2025 – 12/2025
Schwieberdingen, Germany

- Energy-Management & Degradation:** Engineered a MATLAB operating strategy for Strong Fuel Cell Hybrid EVs that safeguards fuel-cell and HV-battery degradation by managing dynamic loads, thermal stress, low-voltage operation, SOC swing and life cycles, parameterised via MAPs for different battery capacities and drive cycles.
- Model Development & Validation:** Developed and validated an iterative Simulink power-split operating-strategy model in the (FC)EVsim module, correlating outputs against reference measurement data to ensure high model fidelity.
- Optimisation & Benchmarking:** Executed multi-objective parametric optimisation (Genetic Algorithms, Gradient Descent) to generate control MAPs for charge sustenance and minimal fuel consumption, benchmarked against DP and ECMS; co-authoring a peer-reviewed paper on the strategy.

Fuel Cell Systems & Test-Bench Lead (Team Lead)
Ecogenium e.V (RWTH student team), Shell Eco-Marathon

06/2024 – Present
Aachen, Germany

- Air-Cooled Fuel Cell Test Bench:** Engineered, fabricated and electronically integrated a standalone fuel cell test bench; ran purging, humidity cycling, short-circuiting and polarisation-curve experiments and mapped the stack's optimal thermal operating window.
- Energy-Management & Thermal Control:** Architected and deployed energy-management and fuel-cell temperature-control strategies in Python/Simulink (MIL-validated), boosting on-track fuel efficiency by ~80% and securing a runner-up finish at Shell Eco-Marathon 2025.
- System Integration:** Designed and tested a compact fuel cell system rig, optimising packaging density and integration of the fuel cell and its electronic systems for Germany's only student-built hydrogen fuel cell vehicle.

KEY SKILLS

Fuel Cell Systems

PEM fuel cell systemsair-cooled stack operationbalance of plantthermal managementsystem sizingcomponent selectionFCEV powertrain

Controls & Strategy

operating strategyenergy management (EMS)degradation / SOH analysisMAP / lookup-table optimisationDP / ECMS benchmarking

Test & Experimentation

FC test-bench designpolarisation curvespurging / humidity cyclingdata acquisitionmodel validation

Simulation & Modelling

MATLAB/Simulink (MIL)digital twinANSYSStar-CCM+Dymola

Programming & Data

Python (NumPy, Pandas, scikit-learn)C/C++Power BI

CAD

CATIA V5Siemens NXFusion 360

EDUCATION

M.Sc. Automotive Engineering
RWTH Aachen University

09/2023 – 06/2026
GPA 1.7 (1.2 core courses)

Modules: Fuel Cell System Technology, Alternative & Mobile Propulsion Systems, Thermodynamics, Simulation Sciences, FEM/CFD. Thesis: fuel cell system control (MATLAB/C++).

B.Tech Mechanical Engineering
Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University, Hyderabad

06/2019 – 04/2023
GPA 1.3 (German scale)

SELECTED PROJECTS & PUBLICATIONS

- Co-author (in preparation): rule-based FCEV powertrain control strategy, based on the Bosch internship.
- Electric Wheelchair with Modular Battery System (ISEA-RWTH): battery-pack architecture, cell selection, Simulink discharge/range model.
- Paper: A Comprehensive Analysis of Two Innovative Aircraft Design Configurations (IJSED).

LANGUAGES

English (C1, fluent) · German (B1, intermediate) · Telugu / Hindi (native)